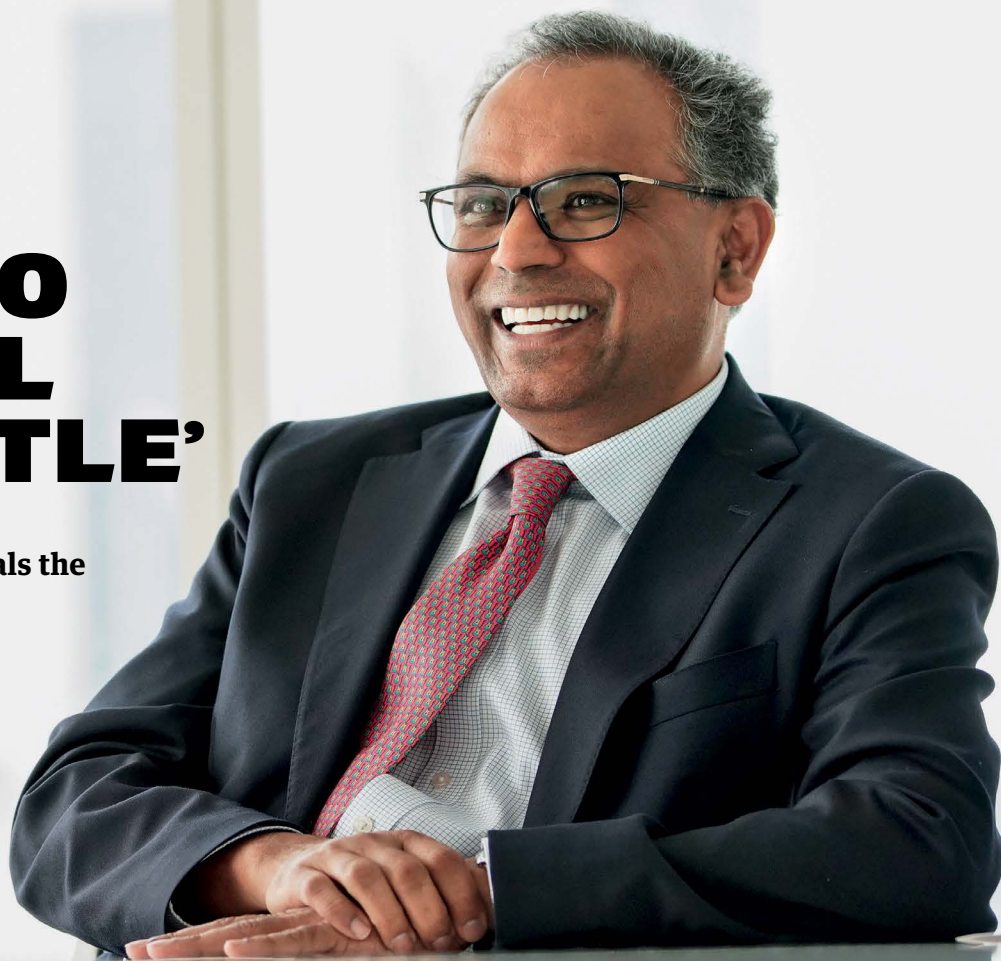




‘TIME TO GO FULL THROTTLE’

Rajiv Jain, Chairman and CIO of GQG Partners, reveals the thinking behind investing in the Adani Group

BY ANAND ADHIKARI



PHOTOS BY GETTY IMAGES

IN THE WORLD of finance, some may argue that Rajiv Jain, Chairman and Chief Investment Officer (CIO) of GQG Partners, is playing with fire. But this Fort Lauderdale, Florida-headquartered private equity firm has found its special sauce with its successful investment strategies. Whether it's HDFC Bank or ITC, Jain's strategy has been to get in early, thereby maximising returns for his global clients. His investments in

the Adani Group—more than \$4 billion—have attracted considerable attention due to the controversies surrounding the conglomerate. But the 55-year-old, who has a knack for seizing opportunities amidst challenges, is betting on his investment experience of more than three decades to come through for his clients. In an exclusive interview with *Business Today*, Jain decodes his investment thesis. Edited excerpts:

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What were your investments in India before the Adani Group?

We launched GQG Partners seven years ago and I am very grateful to have got such a strong response from thousands of sophisticated institutions and pension funds from all over the world. We currently manage around \$104 billion and offer four core equity strategies. We have approximately \$14 billion of our overall investment

book in India. I first started investing in India in the early 1990s, when the markets first opened for FIIs [foreign institutional investors]. So, I have seen more than a few economic cycles. And there have been times when I have had significantly larger positions. About a decade ago, I had more than 5 per cent each in ITC and HDFC Bank... So, I like to make large, concentrated bets. Our India book is relatively concentrated in just a handful of names.